

Archos AV 400

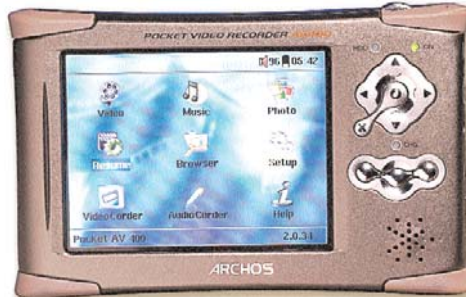
Video On The Go

This 20GB device is only slightly bigger than your regular iPod but does much more! For starters, it plays video (MPEG-4 and AVI in DivX format), audio (MP3, WAV, WMA) and JPEG and BMP images.

To be fair, the 3.5-inch screen is not spectacularly big like its sibling, the Archos AV700's, but the clarity is excellent.

It has a four-way navigation key and a centre-click button. A sixth button is used for going back in the menu structure. Unlike iPods, where you need iTunes, the AV400 is recognised as a removable drive in Windows XP and you can copy files using Windows Explorer. When you unplug it, a scan is automatically performed and each file is classified under Artist, Genre, Album, Title and so on. Updating 1 GB of new music took less than 3 seconds. We were floored!

The interface is brilliant, fast and vivid. The player has an inbuilt CF reader and an additional 4-in-1 adapter can be bought to let you insert any kind of memory card directly into the device. It has a book-marking feature—click 'Resume'



to continue from where you left off in a movie or song.

It comes bundled with Virtual dub and a front-end proprietary software, which ensures that all encoding settings are just right for the movie to play. In our tests though, even unoptimised movies played without framing. The included headphones are strictly decent.

Archos also bundles a hub which allows you to record and playback movies or images to a TV. The recording is limited to just 2 GB per file. It can also be used as a Dictaphone.

You can rename files and create/delete folders and playlists directly from within the player. The battery life is just about adequate for 3 hours of video and 11 hours for music.

The product is amazing but we would've liked a bigger hard disk for more movie storage.

Available from **The Gadget Boy (Inorbit Mall, Malad, Mumbai)**

Price **Rs 29,999**

Phone **022-56880270** Web site **www.archos.com**

Rating



02 XDA Iii

XDA Again

The XDA Iii boasts significant enhancements over the older XDA II. Featuring the same design, the XDA Iii is a PDA phone with Windows Mobile 2003 Second Edition for Pocket PC Phone Edition.

Its enhancements include added Wi-Fi (802.11b) support, a faster processor (Intel PXA 272 running at 520 MHz as compared to the 400 MHz CPU in the XDA II), double the ROM at 128MB, and a 1.3 megapixel camera. Other specifications of the XDA Iii include tri-band GPRS, a 3.5-inch 240 x 320 touchscreen supporting 65K colours, 128 MB SDRAM, SDIO slot, Infrared and Bluetooth v1.2.

Pre-installed applications include Pocket Excel, Word, Internet Explorer, MSN Messenger, Windows Media Player 10, Java MIDlet Manager (J2ME), Photo Contacts, PowerPoint and PDF viewer, and much more... The device connects to a PC using the bundled USB

cable and Microsoft ActiveSync 3.8 included on the CD.

The 520 MHz CPU is zippy and handles most applications, multimedia and games with ease, even while multitasking. Phone clarity on the XDA Iii is excellent, and the 1.3-megapixel camera produces decent results—provided lighting conditions are good.

To sum up, the XDA Iii is a worthy buy for corporate users who want to stay connected on the move. However, others can opt for an entry-level notebook at a similar price!

Company **Creative E-Biz.com**

Price **Rs 45,888**

Phone **022-5631 4845**

E-mail **cr_mum@yahoo.com**

Web site **www.seeo2.com**

Rating



Jabra BT 800

Jabra has finally made its way to Indian shores. The BT800 Bluetooth headset, Jabra's flagship model, is packed with impressive features.

The BT800 looks chunky, but at 22 gms, is quite light. The skinny ear loop does a good job of holding the BT800 comfortably in place.

It has an integrated, one-line, backlit LCD display that lets you see the caller ID. This feature comes handy since you can identify the caller without pulling the phone out of your pocket or bag. When we tested the headset with a Motorola A780, we were able to see the caller's number, but not the name from the phonebook. Test the device with your phone to make sure all advanced features work before buying it.

Jabra provided a power adapter and a USB connector to charge the BT800. It supports voice dialling from the cell phone address book, has five polyphonic ring tones and even a mild vibrate mode.

During testing, the BT800 performed well; the onboard DSP was able to cut through most of the background noise.

Sensibly priced at Rs 6,500, this product should be on your buying list.

Company **Faxtel Systems (India)**

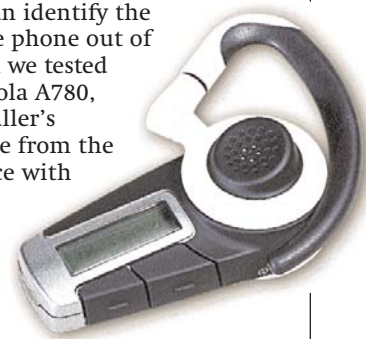
Price **Rs 6,500**

Phone **022-6113055/6115524**

E-mail **faxtel@bom4.vsnl.net.in**

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Rating



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1 Poor: Has serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for its target application. **2 Mediocre:** Does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas. **3 Average:** Reasonably competent, but nothing spectacular about the product. **4 Good:** A good buy, better than most products in its category. **5 Excellent:** A brilliant combination of price, performance and features—far beyond expectations.